Scott Colom Wins a Historic Senate Seat in Mississippi

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Mississippi has a new senator, and his win made history.

Democrat Scott Colom beat Republican Senator Cindy Hyde-Smith in a close race that took days of counting **ballots** to settle. Colom, a 43-year-old local **prosecutor**, will become Mississippi's first Black U.S. senator since the years right after the Civil War, a time known as **Reconstruction**. That is a big deal in a state where white **conservatives** have held power for generations. The last new Democratic senator in Mississippi was picked in 1947, and he supported **segregation**, the system that kept Black and white people apart by law.

Colom built his campaign around listening. 'They actually deserve a senator that will listen to them,' he said. He said he could represent all of Mississippi, a state where race has long shaped politics and daily life.

Colom's win adds to midterm losses for President Donald Trump's party. Democratic Senate leader Chuck Schumer celebrated the result. Former President Bill Clinton and former Vice President Kamala Harris campaigned for Colom in the closing weeks. Now he heads to Washington as Mississippi's next senator.

Word Treasure

ballots -- Ballots are the papers or forms voters use to mark who they choose in an election.

prosecutor -- A prosecutor is a lawyer who works for the government to bring a case against someone in court.

Reconstruction -- Reconstruction was the time right after the Civil War when the country worked to rebuild and change its rules.

segregation -- Segregation was a system of laws that kept Black and white people apart.

conservatives -- Conservatives are people who want to keep things mostly the way they are and change slowly.

Background you need

A senator is a person voters choose to help make laws for their state in Washington.

In Mississippi, voters picked a new senator in a close race that took days of counting ballots to settle.

His win is historic because he will be the state's first Black senator since the years right after the Civil War.

Break it down

WHO: Scott Colom, Senator Cindy Hyde-Smith, Chuck Schumer, Bill Clinton, and Kamala Harris.

WHAT: Scott Colom won the Senate seat in Mississippi, beating Cindy Hyde-Smith in a close race.

WHERE: In Mississippi, and next he heads to Washington as the state's next senator.

WHY: Voters chose Colom in the midterm election after he campaigned on listening to people across the state.

Why it matters

The people who represent your state help make rules that affect your family, your school, and your community.

Test what you remember

1. Who won the Senate seat in Mississippi?

- (A) Bill Clinton
- (B) Scott Colom
- (C) Cindy Hyde-Smith
- (D) Chuck Schumer

2. Who did Scott Colom beat in the race?

- (A) Senator Cindy Hyde-Smith
- (B) A local prosecutor
- (C) Kamala Harris
- (D) Donald Trump

3. What makes Colom's win historic?

- (A) He won every vote in the state
- (B) He is the youngest senator ever
- (C) He will be Mississippi's first Black U.S. senator since Reconstruction
- (D) He was picked in 1947

4. When was the last new Democratic senator in Mississippi picked?

- (A) In the closing weeks
- (B) In 1865
- (C) In 1947
- (D) Last year

5. What did Colom build his campaign around?

- (A) Moving to Washington
- (B) Counting ballots
- (C) Listening to people
- (D) Supporting segregation

6. Who campaigned for Colom in the closing weeks?

- (A) Former President Bill Clinton and former Vice President Kamala Harris
- (B) Cindy Hyde-Smith and Dan Bartlett
- (C) Lindsay Owens and Elizabeth Pancotti
- (D) President Donald Trump and Chuck Schumer

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: C 4: C 5: C 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Scott Colom: Colom said people deserve a senator that will listen to them and that he could represent all of Mississippi.

2. Chuck Schumer: Schumer celebrated the result.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):